to the West than the other two countries, at least in terms of the flow of ideas and the ability to travel freely to the West.

22. See *Inventing Eastern Europe* in the Bibliography.

23. There is a similar issue in the Baltic states, which prefer to consider themselves Nordic, like the Swedes or the Finns. It is Western Europeans who feel they can, for the sake of simplification, call Estonians Baltic and not Nordic, simply because it is somehow assumed that a former Communist country cannot be placed in the same group as 'fancy' countries like Sweden. The three Baltic countries now take some satisfaction in Nordic-Baltic cooperation (visible, for example, by their embassies abroad jointly celebrating National Days) and by presenting a common stance on EU financial matters through an informal grouping called the New Hanseatic League – a Nordic-Baltic version of Višegrad, mimicking the historic trade alliance in Europe's North.

24. See Tanil Bora, *Turkish national identity, Turkish nationalism and the Balkan problem* in *the Balkans: A Mirror of the New International Order,* Günay Göksu Özdoğan and Kemâli Saybaşih (eds.), Marmara University, 1995.

25. It is interesting to note how the Enlightenment ideals clashed with the Byzantine legacy – at least that was how the Greeks of the day saw this legacy. Averil Cameron writes in *The Byzantines*: 'Against the Enlightenment ideas with which the idea of Greek independence had been invested Byzantium seemed to belong to a tradition of darkness and medievaldom, and to be dangerously associated, especially through the Church, with Ottoman rule…' (p. 177).

26. https://ec.europa.eu/commission/presscorner/detail/en/IP_20_181

27. https://www.france24.com/en/europe/20220509-macron-calls-for-european-political-community-that-could-include-ukraine-uk

28. https://www.reuters.com/article/montenegro-china-road-idUSL5N2NC2VZ